

I'll keep the new reference's **full-family + constructions + specialist-domain + distinction + master-comparison** standard here as well, rather than limiting the entry to the main learner senses.

Word family: **argue / argues / argued / arguing / argument / argumentative / arguably / arguable / argumentation**

Base word: argue

Past tense: argued

Past participle: argued

-ing form: arguing

Major related forms:

- * argument
- * argumentative
- * argumentatively
- * argumentativeness
- * arguable
- * arguably
- * argumentation
- * arguer

Useful negative/opposite forms:

- * unarguable
- * inarguable

Useful compounds/extensions:

- * counterargument
- * argument structure
- * argumentative essay
- * oral argument
- * closing argument
- * command-line argument
- * function argument
- * argument of a complex number

Part of speech: verb (動詞)

Related nouns/adjectives/adverbs: argument, argumentative, arguable, arguably

Your sentence:

> “Some people defend this practice by **arguing that** many Hong Kong students do not have quiet homes...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **argue** means **to present a reason or set of reasons in support of a particular claim or position**.

There is **no implication that the people are angrily quarrelling**.

繁體中文： **主張；提出理由論證；以某項理由支持自己的觀點**

中文翻譯：

> “...by **arguing that** many Hong Kong students do not have quiet homes...”

「.....他們**提出理由 / 主張**，許多香港學生家中沒有安靜的環境.....」

Here:

argue that X = 提出理由支持「X 是真的 / 合理的」這項主張

A. PRESENT REASONS / MAKE A CASE

1. **argue that... = give reasons for believing a claim (論證 / 主張) — 主張；提出理由認為.....**

This is the **exact passage sense**.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Some people **argue that** restaurants provide students with much-needed study space.”

「有些人**主張 / 提出理由認為**，餐廳為學生提供了急需的學習空間。」

Practice 2

> “Researchers **argue that** the change could improve efficiency.”

「研究人員**主張**這項改動可能提高效率。」

Practice 3

> “She **argued that** the evidence was insufficient.”

「她**提出理據指出**證據不足。」

****argue that + clause = 提出理由支持後面的命題****

Very common in:

- * essays
- * academic writing
- * journalism
- * debate
- * legal argument
- * formal discussion

2. ****argue for something = present reasons supporting it (支持) — 為.....提出理據；主張支持****

Practice 4

> “The report ****argues for**** greater investment in public facilities.”

「報告****主張增加****公共設施投資。」

Practice 5

> “She argued strongly ****for**** the proposal.”

「她強力提出理據****支持****這項建議。」

****argue for X = 說明為甚麼 X 應該被接受、採取或相信****

3. ****argue against something = present reasons opposing it (反對) — 提出理由反對.....****

Practice 6

> “He ****argued against**** introducing the new rule.”

「他提出理由****反對****引入新規則。」

Practice 7

> “Several speakers argued against the proposal.”

「幾位發言者都提出理據****反對****這項建議。」

Opposite of:

> argue for.

4. **argue in favour/favor of = formally support through reasoning (贊成) **

Practice 8

> “The essay **argues in favour of** shorter working hours.”

「這篇文章提出論據**支持**縮短工時。」

More formal than:

> argue for.

5. **argue the case for/against something = present a developed case (論證) **

Practice 9

> “The author argues the case for reform.”

「作者提出一套完整理據**支持改革**。」

A strong formal construction.

6. **argue one's case = explain reasons supporting one's request/position (陳述理據) — 據理力爭；陳述自己的理由**

Practice 10

> “Give her a chance to **argue her case**.”

「給她機會**陳述自己的理據**。」

This can be:

* academic;

* workplace;

* legal-like;

* everyday.

It need not involve hostility.

7. **argue a point = present/reinforce a particular point (論點) — 論證某一點**

Practice 11

> “He argued the point very effectively.”

「他非常有效地**論證了那個觀點**。」

But **argue the point** can also mean:

> continue disputing an issue.

Context matters.

8. **argue a position = defend a particular intellectual position (立場) **

> “Students were asked to argue a position they did not personally support.”

「學生被要求**論證一個自己未必認同的立場**。」

Useful in debate/education.

9. **argue one's side = state reasons supporting one's side (陳述己方立場) **

> “Both groups were allowed to argue their side.”

「雙方都有機會**陳述自己的理據**。」

10. **argue both sides = present reasons for both positions (正反論證) **

Practice 12

> “A strong essay should understand and, where appropriate, **argue both sides**.”

「一篇好的文章應理解並在適當情況下**分析正反雙方的論點**。」

This does not necessarily mean personally supporting both sides.

B. REASON FROM EVIDENCE / PREMISES

11. **argue from something = reason on the basis of it (根據.....推論) **

Practice 13

> “The author **argues from** historical evidence.”

「作者**根據歷史證據作出論證**。」

Common:

- * argue from evidence
- * argue from principle
- * argue from analogy
- * argue from experience

12. **argue from analogy = reason using similarity (類比論證) **

> “He argues from analogy with earlier cases.”

「他以較早的案例作為**類比論證**。」

A standard academic/philosophical construction.

13. **argue on the basis of X = base reasoning on X (以.....為依據) **

Practice 14

> “They argued on the basis of the available data.”

「他們以現有數據**作為論證依據**。」

14. **argue from first principles = reason from basic assumptions (從基本原理推論) **

A formal philosophical/scientific expression.

15. **argue by analogy / induction / deduction**

Academic reasoning terminology:

* argue by analogy = 類比論證

* argue inductively = 歸納論證

* argue deductively = 演繹論證

These describe the form of reasoning rather than new lexical senses of **argue**.

C. ACADEMIC / ESSAY DISCOURSE

16. **I would argue that... = measured way to present a thesis (我會主張.....) **

Very common in academic prose.

Practice 15

> “I would **argue that** the policy addresses only part of the problem.”

「我會**主張**這項政策只處理了問題的一部分。」

The conditional **would** often softens the claim.

It does not necessarily mean uncertainty.

17. **it can/could be argued that... = a defensible interpretation is that... (可以說.....) **

Practice 16

> “It could be **argued that** the current arrangement is inefficient.”

「**可以提出一種看法**，認為目前的安排效率不高。」

Often used to introduce:

* an interpretation;

- * a counterpoint;
- * a cautious thesis.

18. **as X argues = according to X's reasoning (正如 X 所主張) **

> “As the author argues, access alone does not guarantee equality.”

「正如作者所**論證 / 主張**，有使用機會並不必然等於平等。」

19. **the paper/article/book argues that... **

Academic works can metaphorically **argue**.

Practice 17

> “The article **argues that** urban design affects social behaviour.”

「這篇文章**主張 / 論證**城市設計會影響社會行為。」

Obviously the physical document is not speaking; this means:

> the author develops that argument in the work.

D. DISAGREE / QUARREL

20. **argue with someone = disagree verbally (爭論) — 與某人爭論；爭吵**

This is the other major everyday meaning.

Practice 18

> “I don't want to **argue with** you.”

「我不想跟你**爭論 / 吵架**。」

Practice 19

> “The two customers began **arguing**.”

「兩名顧客開始**爭吵**。」

The tone can range from:

* calm disagreement
to
* angry quarrelling.

Context determines intensity.

21. **argue about something = disagree about a topic (為.....爭論) **

Practice 20

> “They were **arguing about** money.”

「他們正為金錢問題**爭吵**。」

22. **argue over something = dispute who/what/how (為.....爭持) **

Practice 21

> “The children **argued over** who should sit by the window.”

「孩子們為誰應該坐窗邊而**爭論**。」

argue over is especially natural for:

* ownership
* choice
* control
* details
* money

23. **argue with each other = 互相爭吵**

> “They argue with each other constantly.”

「他們經常互相**爭吵**。」

24. **argue back = reply defiantly/disagree with authority (頂嘴) — 回嘴 ; 頂嘴**

Practice 22

> “Don't **argue back** when I'm explaining the rules.”

「我在解釋規則時不要**頂嘴**。」

Often used by:

- * parents
- * teachers
- * supervisors

and can imply perceived disrespect.

25. **argue the toss — BrE informal = continue disputing a decision (爭論不休) **

> “There's no point arguing the toss now.”

「現在再為這個決定**爭論不休**也沒有用。」

British informal and lower priority, but established.

26. **argue until you're blue in the face = argue endlessly without success (爭到口乾也沒用) **

Practice 23

> “You can **argue until you're blue in the face**, but he won't change his mind.”

「你就算**爭辯到筋疲力盡**，他也不會改變主意。」

Idiomatic and emphatic.

27. **argue for argument's sake = argue merely because you enjoy disagreement (為爭辯而爭辯) **

> “He's not genuinely opposed; he's just arguing for argument's sake.”

「他並不是真的反對，只是**為爭辯而爭辯**。」

E. PERSUADE THROUGH ARGUMENT

28. **argue someone into doing something = persuade by reasoning (說服) — 說服某人做.....**

Practice 24

> “They **argued him into** staying.”

「他們用一番道理**說服他留下來**。」

This is less common than:

> persuade someone to...

but fully established.

29. **argue someone out of doing something = persuade them not to do it (勸服不要做) **

Practice 25

> “She **argued me out of** resigning.”

「她用道理**說服我不要辭職**。」

This is a useful construction.

30. **argue someone around/round to a view = persuade them gradually (說服轉變立場) **

Especially BrE:

> “Eventually they argued him round.”

「最後他們終於**說服他改變立場**。」

Lower priority but established.

F. LEGAL ARGUMENT

31. **argue a case = present legal reasoning to a court (法律) — 為案件陳詞；提出法律論證**

Practice 26

> “Counsel **argued the case** before the court.”

「律師在法院就案件**提出法律陳詞 / 論證**。」

This is a major legal sense.

32. **argue before a court/judge = present submissions (在法院陳詞) **

> “The appeal was argued before a panel of judges.”

「這宗上訴在法官席前進行了**法律陳詞**。」

33. **argue that the law requires X (法律主張) **

> “The claimant argued that the contract was invalid.”

「申索方**主張**該合約無效。」

Same core reasoning sense, applied legally.

34. **argue a motion/appeal = make submissions concerning it (法律程序) **

> argue an appeal

> argue a motion

= 就上訴 / 動議提出法律論證。

35. **oral argument = formal spoken submissions to a court (口頭陳詞) **

Especially prominent in appellate proceedings.

****繁體中文：***口頭辯論 / 口頭陳詞****

Exact courtroom terminology varies by jurisdiction.

36. ****closing argument = final advocacy to fact-finder (結案陳詞) ****

Especially American courtroom terminology.

In other systems, terms such as:

> closing submission(s)

may be preferred.

37. ****legal argument = proposition/reasoning presented in law (法律論證) ****

Can refer to:

- * a specific contention;
- * the reasoning supporting it;
- * counsel's submissions more generally.

G. ****ARGUMENT — DISAGREEMENT****

38. ****an argument = verbal disagreement/quarrel (爭吵) — 爭論；爭吵****

Practice 27

> “They had an ****argument**** about money.”

「他們為金錢問題****吵了一架****。」

Practice 28

> “An argument broke out near the entrance.”

「入口附近突然發生了****爭吵****。」

Common:

- * have an argument
- * get into an argument
- * start an argument
- * argument breaks out
- * heated argument

39. **have an argument with someone (與某人吵架) **

> “I had an argument with my brother.”

「我和哥哥 / 弟弟**吵了一架**。」

This most naturally suggests an interpersonal dispute, not a formal academic argument.

40. **heated argument = 激烈爭論**

> “They became involved in a heated argument.”

「他們陷入一場**激烈爭論**。」

H. **ARGUMENT — REASON SUPPORTING A POSITION**

41. **an argument = a reason or set of reasons supporting a conclusion (論據) — 論點 ; 理由 ; 論據**

Practice 29

> “That is a strong **argument** for expanding public study space.”

「那是支持擴大公共學習空間的一個有力**論據**。」

Practice 30

> “The main **argument against** the proposal is its cost.”

「反對這項建議的主要**理由 / 論點**是成本。」

Common:

* argument for

- * argument against
- * strong argument
- * weak argument
- * convincing argument

42. **argument for X = supporting reason (支持論據) **

> “One argument for the change is greater flexibility.”

「支持這項改動的一個**理由**是彈性更大。」

43. **argument against X = opposing reason (反對論據) **

> “The strongest argument against it is cost.”

「反對它最有力的**論據**是成本。」

44. **counterargument = opposing argument (反駁論點) **

Practice 31

> “A strong essay should address the main **counterargument**.”

「好的文章應該回應主要的**反方論點 / 反駁論點**。」

Extremely useful in essay writing.

I. **ARGUMENT — CONNECTED CASE / LINE OF REASONING**

45. **argument = an organized chain of reasoning leading to a conclusion (論證) **

Practice 32

> “The author's **argument** develops over three chapters.”

「作者的**論證**在三章中逐步展開。」

Here **argument** is larger than one individual reason.

It can mean:

> the entire intellectual case.

46. **line of argument = particular chain/direction of reasoning (論證思路) **

Practice 33

> “I found his line of **argument** difficult to follow.”

「我很難跟上他的**論證思路**。」

47. **central/main argument = central thesis and reasoning (核心論點) **

> “The central argument of the essay is that public space should serve multiple groups.”

「文章的**核心論點**是公共空間應服務多個群體。」

48. **develop/build an argument = construct reasoning (建立論證) **

> “Use evidence to build your argument.”

「使用證據來**建立你的論證**。」

49. **make an argument = present a reasoned case (提出論點) **

> “She makes a persuasive argument for reform.”

「她提出了支持改革的有力**論證**。」

50. **support an argument = provide evidence/reasoning (支持論點) **

> “The data support the argument.”

「數據**支持這項論點**。」

51. **undermine an argument = weaken its reasoning (削弱論點) **

> “The missing data undermine the argument.”

「欠缺數據**削弱了這項論證**。」

52. **an argument holds / does not hold = reasoning is/is not valid or persuasive (成立 / 不成立) **

> “That argument does not hold.”

「那個論點**站不住腳**。」

Formal/academic.

J. FORMAL LOGIC

53. **argument = premises offered in support of a conclusion (邏輯) — 論證**

In formal logic, an **argument** consists broadly of:

- * one or more premises;
- * a conclusion claimed to follow from them.

Example:

- > All mammals are warm-blooded.
- > Whales are mammals.
- > Therefore, whales are warm-blooded.

This is an **argument**, even though nobody is quarrelling.

54. **valid argument = 有效論證**

In deductive logic, an argument is **valid** if it is impossible for all premises to be true while the conclusion is false, given the argument's logical form.

****Valid**** does not mean:

> all premises are actually true.

55. ****sound argument = 健全 / 可靠論證****

A deductive argument is normally called ****sound**** if:

1. it is valid; and
2. its premises are true.

Thus:

> valid ≠ automatically sound.

56. ****invalid argument = 無效論證****

The conclusion does not follow deductively from the premises.

57. ****inductive argument = 歸納論證****

The premises support the conclusion with some degree of probability rather than deductive necessity.

58. ****deductive argument = 演繹論證****

The conclusion is presented as necessarily following from the premises.

59. ****argument form = 論證形式****

The structural logical pattern underlying an argument.

60. ****fallacious argument = 謬誤論證****

An argument involving defective reasoning/fallacy.

K. RHETORIC / WRITING

61. **argumentative essay** = essay presenting and supporting a position (議論文)

Practice 34

> “Students must write an **argumentative essay**.”

「學生必須寫一篇**議論文 / 論證性文章**。」

Meaning:

> a structured piece of writing presenting a claim and supporting reasons/evidence.

This does **not** mean:

> an essay written in an angry, quarrelsome tone.

62. **argumentative writing** = 論證性寫作

Common educational term.

Usually includes:

- * claim/thesis
- * evidence
- * reasoning
- * counterarguments
- * rebuttal

63. **argumentation** = process/system of reasoning and arguing (論證)

Practice 35

> “The course teaches critical thinking and **argumentation**.”

「課程教授批判思考和**論證技巧**。」

More formal/academic than **argument**.

64. **argumentation theory** = 論證理論

Academic field concerned with:

- * argument structure;
- * reasoning;
- * persuasion;
- * dialogue;
- * fallacies.

65. **argumentative structure** = 論證結構

Can refer to how a text organizes:

- * claims;
- * evidence;
- * counterclaims;
- * conclusions.

L. **ARGUMENTATIVE — PERSONALITY**

66. **argumentative** = inclined to argue/quarrel (好爭辯的) — 好爭論的 ; 愛抬槓的

Practice 36

> “He becomes **argumentative** when he is tired.”

「他累的時候很容易變得**愛爭辯 / 愛抬槓**。」

This often has a negative tone.

67. **argumentative person/tone** = 好爭辯的人 / 語氣

> “Her tone became argumentative.”

「她的語氣開始變得**挑戰性很強、愛爭辯**。」

68. **argumentative ≠ good at argument**

A person who is **argumentative** is not necessarily:

> skilled at logical reasoning.

It usually means:

> frequently inclined to dispute/challenge.

M. **ARGUMENTATIVE — WRITING / RHETORIC**

69. **argumentative = presenting reasons in support of a position (論證性的)**

Practice 37

> “The assignment requires an **argumentative** structure.”

「這份作業要求採用**論證性結構**。」

Here the word is neutral/academic.

So:

> argumentative person

> = 好爭辯

but:

> argumentative essay

> = 議論 / 論證性的文章

Very different connotations.

70. **argumentative question — legal/trial advocacy (誘導爭辯式問題)**

In courtroom practice, a question may be objected to as **argumentative** when it effectively:

* argues with the witness;

- * challenges rather than genuinely seeks factual testimony;
- * embeds counsel's inference/argument.

Exact evidentiary practice varies by jurisdiction.

Specialist legal adjective sense.

71. **argumentatively = in an argumentative manner (爭辯地 / 以論證方式) **

Can mean:

interpersonal

> in a quarrelsome/challenging way

academic

> by means of argumentation

The first is more likely in ordinary English.

72. **argumentativeness = tendency to argue (好爭辯) **

A noun describing:

> tendency/disposition to engage in arguments.

Used especially in:

- * psychology
- * communication studies
- * personality description

N. **ARGUABLE**

73. **arguable = capable of being supported by reasonable argument (可以辯護 / 成立的) **

Practice 38

> "There is an **arguable** case for changing the rule."

「有一套**站得住腳的理由**支持修改規則。」

Meaning:

> the position is not necessarily proven, but there are reasonable arguments supporting it.

74. **arguable = open to dispute; debatable (有爭議的) **

Practice 39

> “Whether this is the best solution is **arguable**.”

「這是否是最佳方案是**可以爭議的 / 值得商榷的**。」

Interesting feature:

arguable can mean both:

1. defensible;
2. debatable.

Context tells you which nuance dominates.

75. **an arguable case = reasonably supportable case (有合理理據的主張) **

Common in:

- * law
- * academic analysis
- * formal discussion

76. **arguable point = point that can reasonably be debated/supported**

> “That's an arguable point.”

Could mean:

> 這一點有一定道理 / 值得爭論。

Context-sensitive.

O. **ARGUABLY**

77. **arguably** = it can reasonably be argued that (可以說) — 可以說；有理由認為

Practice 40

> “This is **arguably** the most important issue in the report.”

「這**可以說是**報告中最重要問題。」

Practice 41

> “She is arguably the team's most versatile player.”

「她**可以說是**球隊中最全面的球員。」

arguably = 有一套合理論據可以支持這個說法

It does not mean:

> indisputably.

In fact, it explicitly leaves room for disagreement.

78. **arguably** ≠ perhaps

perhaps

simply signals possibility.

arguably

signals:

> a reasoned case could be made.

Compare:

> “Perhaps this is the best option.”

= 可能是。

> “Arguably, this is the best option.”

= 有合理理由可以主張它是。

P. **UNARGUABLE / INARGUABLE**

79. **unarguable = impossible to dispute successfully (無可爭辯的) **

> “The evidence is unarguable.”

「證據是**無可爭辯的**。」

80. **inarguable = indisputable (無可爭辯的) **

Same broad meaning.

Both exist.

In many contexts, more common alternatives are:

* undeniable

* indisputable

* incontrovertible

Q. **ARGUER**

81. **arguer = person who argues (論辯者 / 爭辯者) **

A valid noun, especially in:

* logic

* rhetoric

* debate theory

Example:

> “A good arguer must respond to counterarguments.”

「好的**論辯者**必須回應反方論點。」

In everyday speech, English usually prefers:

> person arguing

> debater

depending on context.

R. MATHEMATICS — FUNCTION ARGUMENT

82. **argument of a function = input/independent variable (數學) — 函數的自變量 / 輸入值**

For:

> $f(x)$

x can be called the **argument** of the function.

Example:

> “Evaluate the function at the argument $x=2$.”

「在自變量 / 輸入值 $x=2$ 時求函數值。」

This is a completely distinct technical noun sense.

83. **argument value = supplied input to a function**

In mathematical/computational contexts:

> function argument

= value/expression supplied to the function.

S. COMPLEX NUMBERS

84. **argument of a complex number = angle from positive real axis (複數) — 輻角**

For a nonzero complex number z , an **argument** is an angle describing its direction from the

positive real axis.

Standard notation includes:

$\arg(z)$

****繁體中文 : **輻角****

Because angles differing by multiples of (2π) can represent the same direction, complex analysis may distinguish:

- * an argument;
- * the principal argument.

85. ****principal argument = 主輻角****

A conventionally selected argument from a specified interval.

The exact interval convention should be checked in the mathematical context.

T. COMPUTING — FUNCTION ARGUMENT

86. ****argument = value passed to a function/method/program (電腦) — 引數 / 實參****

Example:

```
```text
print("hello")
```
```

`"hello"` is an ****argument**** passed to `print`.

****繁體中文 : ** commonly **引數 / 實參****, depending on local terminology.

87. ****argument vs parameter — computing****

This distinction is very important.

****parameter****

= variable/name defined by the function.

argument

= actual value/expression supplied when calling it.

Example:

```
```text
function greet(name) ...
greet("Amy")
```
```

* `name` = parameter

* `"Amy"` = argument

In informal programming discussion, however, the terms are sometimes used loosely.

88. **positional argument = 位置引數**

Its meaning is determined largely by its position in the call.

89. **keyword/named argument = 關鍵字 / 具名引數**

The argument is associated explicitly with a parameter name.

Exact syntax depends on programming language.

90. **optional argument = 選用引數**

An argument that does not always need to be supplied because:

* default value;

* overload;

* optional parameter mechanism;

depending on language/API.

U. COMMAND-LINE ARGUMENTS

91. **command-line argument** = value supplied when launching a program (命令列參數 / 引數)

Example:

```
```text
program --verbose file.txt
```
```

The extra tokens supplied after the program name are commonly called:

> command-line arguments.

92. **argument list** = list of supplied arguments (引數列表)

Used in:

- * programming languages
- * function calls
- * command-line processing

V. LINGUISTICS

93. **argument** = participant syntactically/semantically associated with a predicate (語言學) — 論元

In linguistics, an **argument** is a participant/expression selected or licensed by a predicate.

Example:

> “Alice opened the door.”

For **open**, relevant arguments can include:

- * Alice
- * the door

depending on the syntactic/semantic analysis.

繁體中文： **論元**

This is completely unrelated to quarrelling.

94. **argument structure = predicate's pattern of arguments (論元結構) **

A major linguistics term.

It concerns:

- * how many arguments a predicate has;
- * their semantic roles;
- * how they map onto syntax.

95. **argument vs adjunct — linguistics**

argument

is more tightly associated with the predicate's lexical/semantic requirements.

adjunct

adds optional information such as:

- * time;
- * place;
- * manner;

depending on analysis.

The boundary is not always trivial and differs across linguistic frameworks.

96. **external/internal argument**

Technical syntactic terms used in various theories.

- * external argument
- * internal argument

Definitions depend on the theoretical framework.

W. OLDER / LITERARY **ARGUMENT**

97. **argument = summary/theme of a literary work (文學 / 舊式) — 梗概 ; 主題摘要**

In older literary usage, an **argument** can mean:

> a summary or statement of the subject/content of a poem, chapter, book, etc.

You may see headings such as:

> “The Argument”

before an older poem or canto.

Database status: genuine historical/literary sense, lower priority.

X. IMPORTANT FIXED EXPRESSIONS

98. **for the sake of argument = assume something temporarily for discussion (姑且假設) **

Practice 42

> “For the sake of **argument**, suppose the plan costs nothing.”

「**為了方便討論，我們姑且假設**這個方案沒有成本。」

This does not mean:

> because we enjoy quarrelling.

It means:

> temporarily accept a proposition so its implications can be examined.

99. **for argument's sake = for purposes of discussion / sometimes just to argue**

Depending on context:

neutral

> assume X for discussion.

critical

> argue merely because one likes disputing.

So context matters.

100. **no argument from me = I agree / I won't object (我沒有異議) **

Informal:

> "We should leave early."

> "No argument from me."

「我**沒有異議 / 我同意**。」

101. **you can't argue with X = X is hard to deny or dispute (無可否認) **

Practice 43

> "You can't **argue with** the results."

「這個結果是**無可否認的**。」

Here **argue with** does not mean literally quarrel with the results.

Meaning:

> evidence is too strong to dispute.

102. **there's no arguing with X = impossible to dispute/persuade**

Can mean:

fact/evidence

> impossible to deny it.

person

> the person will not be persuaded.

Example:

> “There's no arguing with him once he's made up his mind.”

「他一旦決定了，就**沒辦法跟他講道理 / 說服他**。」

103. **win/lose an argument**

interpersonal/debate

> “She won the argument.”

= 她在辯論中佔了上風 / 說服了對方。

This is informal and does not necessarily mean the reasoning was objectively correct.

104. **settle an argument = resolve a disagreement (解決爭議) **

> “The evidence finally settled the argument.”

「證據最終**解決了爭議**。」

105. **get into an argument = become involved in a quarrel (陷入爭吵) **

> “He got into an argument with another customer.”

「他和另一位顧客**吵了起來**。」

106. **avoid an argument = avoid a quarrel/dispute (避免爭吵) **

Y. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

argue vs discuss

discuss

= exchange ideas/information.

It need not involve disagreement.

argue

can mean:

1. present reasons supporting a view; or
2. disagree.

> discuss the issue

> argue about the issue

The second more strongly signals conflict.

argue vs debate

debate

usually suggests a structured or serious exchange of opposing views.

argue

is broader:

- * academic reasoning;
- * courtroom advocacy;
- * everyday quarrelling.

> formal debate

> argument with your brother

argue vs quarrel

quarrel

strongly suggests interpersonal conflict, often emotional.

argue

may be perfectly calm and intellectual.

> philosophers argue that...

> neighbours quarrel over noise

So the passage's **argue that** absolutely does **not** mean “吵架說.....”.

argue vs fight

fight

may involve:

* physical violence;

* severe verbal conflict.

argue

normally refers to words/reasoning.

> They argued.

does not imply physical fighting.

argue vs claim

claim

= state that something is true.

argue

= provide reasons supporting that claim.

Compare:

> “She claims the system is unfair.”

She says it is.

> “She argues the system is unfair.”

She presents reasoning for that conclusion.

Important distinction for essays.

argue vs assert

assert

= state confidently/firmly.

argue

= reason in support.

An assertion can be unsupported.

An argument ideally supplies reasons.

argue vs contend

contend that

is a formal synonym of:

> argue that / maintain that.

Common in:

* legal

* academic

* formal journalism.

Contend does not normally have the everyday “quarrel with someone” use to the same degree.

argue vs maintain

maintain that

= continue to state/hold that something is true.

argue that

= support it through reasons.

argue vs reason

reason

focuses on the process of logical thinking.

argue

focuses on presenting/using reasoning for a position.

You can reason privately without arguing anything to anyone.

argue vs persuade

argue

= present reasons.

persuade

= successfully change someone's belief/action.

You can argue very well and still fail to persuade.

argue vs defend

This is exactly relevant to your passage.

defend X

= respond to criticism by protecting/supporting X.

argue that Y

= present Y as the reasoning/proposition supporting the position.

So:

> “They **defend** the practice **by arguing that** students lack space.”

means:

1. **defend** = purpose: support the criticized practice;
2. **argue that** = method/content: present a particular reason.

argument vs opinion

opinion

= what someone believes/thinks.

argument

= reasons used to support a conclusion.

> “I dislike the policy.”

is an opinion.

> “The policy should change because X, Y, and Z.”

is an argument.

argument vs evidence

evidence

= information/data supporting or undermining a claim.

argument

= reasoning connecting evidence/premises to a conclusion.

Evidence does not automatically constitute an argument.

argument vs explanation

explanation

answers:

> why/how did this happen?

argument

tries to establish:

> why should we believe/accept this conclusion?

They can overlap but serve different purposes.

argument vs reason

A **reason** may be one supporting point.

An **argument** may combine several reasons into an organized case.

argument vs thesis

thesis

= central claim/proposition.

argument

= reasoning used to establish/support the thesis.

In looser academic usage, **argument** can sometimes refer to the entire thesis-plus-reasoning package.

argumentative vs aggressive

argumentative

= inclined to dispute/challenge verbally.

aggressive

= hostile/forceful more generally and can include physical behaviour.

An argumentative person is not necessarily aggressive.

argumentative vs assertive

assertive

= confidently expresses one's needs/views while respecting others.

argumentative

= inclined to dispute/challenge.

Very different.

arguable vs questionable

arguable

can mean:

> reasonably supportable OR open to debate.

questionable

usually suggests doubt or possible defect.

> an arguable case

may be reasonably strong.

> a questionable case

sounds doubtful.

****arguably vs definitely****

****arguably****

leaves space for reasonable disagreement.

****definitely****

expresses certainty.

> arguably the best

> definitely the best

Very different strength.

Z. GRAMMAR

107. ****argue that + clause****

> “She argues that the policy is ineffective.”

Most important formal pattern.

108. ****argue for/against + noun/-ing****

> argue for reform

> argue against increasing fees

109. ****argue with + person****

> argue with your colleague

Usually interpersonal disagreement.

110. ****argue about/over + issue****

> argue about money

> argue over ownership

111. **argue + object in legal/formal contexts**

- > argue a case
- > argue a point

But normally not:

> “argue the policy” ❌

if you simply mean discuss it.

Use:

- > argue for/against the policy.

112. **argue someone into/out of + noun/-ing**

- > argue someone into accepting
- > argue someone out of resigning

113. **argue by/from/on the basis of**

Formal reasoning patterns:

- * argue by analogy
- * argue from evidence
- * argue on the basis of principle

AA. COUNTABILITY

argument — disagreement

Countable:

- > an argument
- > several arguments

argument — reason/case

Countable:

- > a strong argument
- > three arguments against the proposal

argument — broader reasoning

Can be treated as a countable intellectual structure:

- > the argument of the chapter
- > several competing arguments

argumentation

Usually uncountable:

- > techniques of argumentation
- > political argumentation

arguer

Countable:

- > an arguer
- > skilled arguers

though relatively uncommon.

AB. FAMILY MAP

| Family member | Main modern meanings |
|---------------|----------------------|
|---------------|----------------------|

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| | | |
|--------------------------------|---|--|
| argue | present reasons; support/oppose a position; disagree/quarrel; persuade through reasoning; make legal submissions | |
| argument | quarrel; supporting reason; organized case/reasoning; formal logical argument; technical input/parameter-like value | |
| argumentative | inclined to quarrel; or structured around argument/reasoning | |
| argumentatively | in a disputatious or argumentative manner | |
| argumentativeness | tendency to argue/dispute | |
| arguable | reasonably defensible; or open to debate | |
| arguably | it can reasonably be argued that | |
| argumentation | process/theory/practice of constructing arguments | |
| arguer | person who argues | |
| unarguable / inarguable | impossible to dispute reasonably | |
| counterargument | argument opposing another argument | |

Master comparison

| Form / sense | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning | |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|--|
| ----- | ----- | |
| argue that X | 提出理由支持「X 為真 / 合理」這項主張 | |
| argue for X | 提出論據支持 X | |
| argue against X | 提出論據反對 X | |
| argue one's case | 有系統地陳述支持自己立場 / 要求的理由 | |
| argue a point/position | 論證某個具體觀點 / 立場 | |
| argue from evidence/principle | 以證據 / 原則作為推論基礎 | |
| argue with someone | 與某人發生口頭爭論 / 爭吵 | |
| argue about/over X | 因 X 而意見不合、爭論 | |
| argue back | 對權威 / 批評回嘴、頂嘴 | |
| argue someone into X | 用理由說服某人做 / 接受 X | |
| argue someone out of X | 用理由說服某人不要做 / 放棄 X | |
| argue a case — law | 在法庭上提出支持一方的法律陳詞 / 論證 | |
| oral argument | 法庭上的正式口頭法律陳詞 | |
| closing argument | 審訊結束前的總結性辯護 / 控方陳詞 | |
| argument — quarrel | 人與人之間的爭論 / 爭吵 | |
| argument — supporting reason | 支持或反對某結論的一項理由 / 論據 | |
| argument — overall case | 一整套有組織的論證思路 | |
| line of argument | 論證的發展方向 / 推理路線 | |
| counterargument | 針對另一論點提出的反方論證 | |

| | | |
|--|-------------------------|--|
| **argument — logic** | 由前提與結論組成、聲稱前提支持結論的論證 | |
| **valid argument** | 從邏輯形式而言，前提真時結論不可能假的演繹論證 | |
| **sound argument** | 有效且前提為真的演繹論證 | |
| **argumentative — person** | 愛爭辯、容易與別人爭論的 | |
| **argumentative — essay/writing** | 以明確立場、論據和證據進行論證的 | |
| **argumentation** | 建構、分析和評估論證的過程 / 方法 | |
| **arguable — defensible** | 有合理論據可支持、站得住腳的 | |
| **arguable — debatable** | 可以爭論 / 值得商榷的 | |
| **arguably** | 有合理理由可以說；可以說是 | |
| **unarguable / inarguable** | 無可爭辯、難以否認的 | |
| **argument — mathematics function** | 函數所取的輸入 / 自變量 | |
| **argument — complex number** | 複數相對正實軸的角度；輻角 | |
| **argument — programming** | 呼叫函數 / 方法時實際傳入的引數 | |
| **command-line argument** | 啟動程式時從命令列傳入的值 / 引數 | |
| **argument — linguistics** | 謂詞在語義 / 句法上選擇或要求的論元 | |
| **argument structure** | 一個謂詞與其論元之間的結構關係 | |
| **argument — historical literary** | 舊式文學作品前的內容梗概 / 主旨摘要 | |
| **for the sake of argument** | 為方便討論而暫時假設某命題成立 | |
| **for argument's sake** | 為討論方便；亦可指純粹為爭辯而爭辯 | |
| **you can't argue with X** | X 太明顯 / 有力，難以合理否認 | |
| **get into an argument** | 與某人吵起來 / 陷入爭論 | |

For your original sentence

> “Some people defend this practice by ****arguing that**** many Hong Kong students do not have quiet homes...”

The exact meaning is:

****arguing that** = 提出「很多學生家中沒有安靜環境」作為支持這種做法的理由

So the logic is:

> ****claim:**** using restaurants for tutoring can be understandable

> ****supporting reason:**** many students lack quiet study space at home.

The word does ****not**** mean:

> 「他們吵架說學生沒有安靜的家」 ❌

Here it is the formal reasoning sense:

> ****argue that** = 主張並提出理據支持某一觀點

The distinction from the previous target is especially useful:

> **defend the practice**
> = 為受到批評的做法辯護

> **argue that students lack space**
> = 提出一個具體命題 / 理由作為辯護內容

For your database, I would keep **5 major base-verb branches** for **argue**:

1. **present reasons supporting a claim — argue that**
2. **present reasons for/against a proposal, position, or action**
3. **disagree or quarrel verbally**
4. **persuade someone through reasoning — argue into/out of**
5. **make formal legal submissions — argue a case**

But for the **whole family**, the database should explicitly index the independently important senses of **argument** in **logic, mathematics, complex numbers, computing, command-line interfaces, linguistics, rhetoric, law, and historical literature**, because these meanings are no longer safely recoverable from the everyday verb alone.